



SESSION 02 · NICHE REFERENCE

The Niche Playbook

The thinking behind this session, in one place — why a niche matters, what makes a good one, the advantage you already hold, and the one line every niche collapses into. The menus carry the lists; this carries the ideas.

01 Why niche at all

02 What makes a good niche

03 Your unfair advantage

04 The formula

Generate wide · choose later — well to better, never treat

You have depth, and no shortage of big ideas — and it's hard to compress them into one thing the market actually wants. That's the therapist's tension exactly, and it's normal. **Niching is how you resolve it:** you don't lose the depth, you point it at one group with one problem. And remember — people aren't looking for a coach, they're looking to bridge a gap in their life.

01 · WHY NICHE AT ALL

A generalist resonates with no one

The instinct of a skilled clinician is to stay broad — "I can help all kinds of people." That is exactly why a broad practice struggles. **The more you specialize, the more your value** — it compounds like a spiral, until you're the one person people ask for. A niche is not a cage; it is the beachhead. You start narrow to earn the right to expand.

Generalist

Targets everybody — and resonates with nobody. The message is written for "everyone," so it moves no one.

Specialist

Targets a specific group with a specific problem. Depth reads as authority; specialist services carry higher perceived value.

Specialist services command **higher perceived value**.

WHAT NICHING DOES FOR YOU

Four benefits

01

You serve, rather than sell

Built for one specific person, reaching them feels like recognition, not persuasion.

02

You become the expert

Depth in one area reads as authority in a way breadth never can.

03

You focus your attention

One group, one problem — instead of scattering across every possible client.

04

Your message resonates

Written for someone specific, not everyone in general — so it actually lands.

02 · WHAT MAKES A GOOD NICHE

Three parts

Not all niches are equal. A strong coaching niche has three parts — and if the pain point is strong enough, it triggers one of the three reasons anyone hires a coach at all. Get this right and everything downstream is easier: **if you don't understand your niche, you can't solve for it.**

A specific group of people

Defined enough that you could picture one of them.

A powerful pain point

The thing that has them staring at the ceiling at night. What do they complain about, again and again?

A clear before & after

A current state they're stuck in, a desired state they want. Coaching is the bridge.

WHY ANYONE HIRES A COACH

The three reasons

Can't get there alone

The goal is real but out of reach without help.

Want to get there faster

They could, eventually — but not soon enough.

Want a proven system

Rather than figuring it out from scratch alone.

TWO FILTERS THAT SHARPEN IT

High-value client · Big domain of life

A high-value client has both the need and the means — value-based pricing only works when they can invest. And the strongest niches sit in a **big domain** people always pay to resolve.

Health & Wellbeing

Energy, performance, a sustainable life.

Wealth

Income, security, building something.

Relationships

Connection, leadership, how we relate.

03 · YOUR UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Mine your clinical experience — then translate the lane

Most new coaches pick a niche off a list and hope. You have sat with particular populations for years and heard the same struggles in their own words — the richest niche-generation source there is. So ask: **which groups do I already know deeply, and what did they keep coming back to?** But carry it into coaching correctly.

✗ THERAPY

Treating a problem

Healing, treating, diagnosing, managing symptoms, restoring function. A different practice, with different ethics and standing.

Not this: "I help executives treat their burnout and manage anxiety."

✓ COACHING

Designing a better future

Designing, building, elevating, moving toward a goal. Well to better — growth-facing, future-facing.

This: "I help high-performing executives design a sustainable way of working and living."

THE TEST FOR EVERY IDEA

Am I helping someone move from **well to better** — or am I **treating** something? The first is coaching. The second is therapy. Same population you understand; a completely different, and entirely legitimate, lane.

04 · THE FORMULA

Every niche collapses into one line

"I help [Audience] achieve [Transformation]."

"I help mothers returning to work rebuild their confidence."

"I help startup founders lead without losing themselves."

"I help newly-promoted executives lead with confidence in their first leadership role."

Generate wide · choose later

This session produces a shortlist — more candidates than you'll keep. Scoring and selecting is Session 3, with its own framework. Don't judge while you generate.

Well → better, never treat

Keep every candidate firmly in the coaching lane. A dropped clinical idea isn't a loss — it's the boundary doing its job.

How to use this. Read it before the pre-work worksheet. Then open the three menus for raw material, and draft your rough "I help..." lines. Bring plenty — we widen the field together on the call, then score and choose next session.